

Skincare Knowledge Entry

Concise extraction from the provided article - no added claims

Core routine steps

1. Cleanse

Use a mild cleanser suited to your skin type. Wash twice daily - morning and before bed - and after sweating.

2. Apply treatment for your main skin concern

Choose a product based on your primary concern and skin type. The article mentions vitamin C and retinoids.

3. Moisturize when needed

Add moisturizer when skin is dry, such as during winter. If a retinoid is too drying, moisturizer can be applied before it.

4. Apply sunscreen

Use SPF 30+, broad-spectrum, water-resistant sunscreen on the face and any exposed skin when going outside during daylight.

When each step is needed

- **Cleanser:** Morning, before bed, and after sweating.
- **Vitamin C:** Morning, after cleansing and before sunscreen.
- **Retinoid:** Before bed; apply 20-30 minutes after washing.
- **Moisturizer:** As needed for dryness; it can be used immediately after cleansing if retinoids are too drying.
- **Sunscreen:** Whenever you will be outside during daylight; apply 15 minutes before going outdoors.

Product categories mentioned

- Mild cleanser
- Hydrating cleanser
- Oil-removing cleanser for acne-prone skin
- Sunscreen
- Tinted sunscreen
- Vitamin C serum or cream
- Retinoids: retinol, adapalene, tazarotene, tretinoin, trifarotene
- Moisturizer
- Acne gels and creams
- Exfoliating products
- Makeup with SPF

Important usage notes

- Choose cleanser, sunscreen, and treatment products according to your skin type and concern.
- For oily skin, look for sunscreen labeled "non-comedogenic" or "won't clog pores."
- Tinted sunscreen may help avoid a white cast on darker skin tones.
- Sunscreen goes after other skincare products and before makeup.
- Retinoids can unclog pores and may help other acne treatments work better.
- If a retinoid is too drying: moisturize immediately after cleansing, then apply the retinoid 20-30 minutes later.
- Stop using a product if it irritates your skin.
- Unless a product is irritating, use it consistently; the article states it takes at least 30 days to judge whether it is working.
- Avoid frequently switching or adding products, which may cause irritation.
- Do not scrub the skin.
- Remove makeup before bed.
- Avoid overusing exfoliating products because this can damage the skin barrier.
- Sun protection also includes seeking shade, wearing protective clothing, sunglasses, and a broad-brimmed hat.
- Makeup with SPF alone requires SPF 30+ and reapplication every two hours to provide the stated SPF benefit.
- See a board-certified dermatologist for skin conditions affecting quality of life, such as eczema or rosacea.